Poliothyrsis sinensis

Chinese pearl-bloom tree, Chinese pearlbloom

Also known as: shan guai zao | Family: Salicaceae



HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Tree

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 30–40 ft tall × 15–25 ft wide in landscape. Up to 50 ft (15 m) in some reports.
Small to medium deciduous tree

Sun

Water

Soil
Fertile, well-drained soil. Adaptable once established

Zone 8a
Hardy in USDA Zones 6–9 or Zones 6–9. RHS rates H6–H7. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a with good drainage and some shelter from cold winds. Generally pest- and disease-free when properly sited

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to central and southern China (Anhui, Fujian, Guangdong, and others). Monotypic genus. Temperate forests, 400–1,500 m elevation. Formerly placed in Flacourtiaceae.
Introduced to U.S. gardens by E. H. Wilson in 1908

Form
Deciduous tree with dense, upright to spreading habit. Sometimes bushy. Graceful small tree. Monotypic Chinese tree valued for glossy foliage, fragrant summer panicles, and interesting fruit. Underused in gardens. Close relatives include Carrierea and Idesia. Good autumn interest in some conditions

Foliage
Ovate to oblong leaves, 8–18 cm long, dark shiny green above, pale and downy beneath when young. Reddish petioles. New growth bronze-flushed or burgundy-bronze, maturing green, turning yellow in fall

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Gray-brown, soon ruggedly fissured or furrowed with age

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in full sun to partial shade with fertile, well-drained soil. Provide shelter from cold winds. Propagate by seed or greenwood cuttings. Minimal pruning. Excellent small garden tree for foliage, summer flowers, and fruit

HEALTH

Health

Generally pest-free and disease-free. Low maintenance. No serious problems stated when properly sited

Symptoms

None stated